DILLON MORGAN CONSULTING

Analyst Assessment: Superstore Revenue Case Study

Time: 60 minutes | Tools: Excel, Power BI, or slides | Deliverable: 5-slide deck and a short video walkthrough

THE SITUATION

You are an analyst at **Superstore**, a US based national retailer selling Furniture, Office Supplies, and Technology to Consumer, Corporate, and Home Office customers across four regions. Over the past four fiscal years (2014 to 2017), revenue has **grown more than 50%**. The CEO is preparing for the annual board review and is worried. She said: "Our top line is up, but I have a feeling we are ***growing the wrong things***. I need someone to look at this honestly and tell me where we are winning, where we are losing money, and what we should change."

THE CEO'S QUESTION: *"Where is our growth healthy, where is it hurting us, and what should we do differently in FY2018?"*

THE DATASET

You have been given the file **Superstore_sales_dataset.xlsx** with **9,994 order line items** across 21 columns. Every row is one product sold in one order. Key columns include:

ORDER INFO	CUSTOMER + GEOGRAPHY	PRODUCT + FINANCIALS
Order ID, Order Date, Ship Date, Ship Mode (Standard, Second Class, First Class, Same Day)	Customer ID, Customer Name, Segment (Consumer, Corporate, Home Office), City, State, Region (East, West, Central, South)	Category (Furniture, Office Supplies, Technology), Sub-Category, Product Name, Sales ($), Quantity, Discount (%), Profit ($)

YOUR APPROACH *(structure your work this way)*

1. IDENTIFY	2. ANALYZE	3. STRUCTURE	4. CONCLUDE	5. SOLVE
Reframe the CEO's question into something measurable.	Compute the right metrics: revenue trends, margins, discount impact, segment splits.	Segment the business into clear buckets. What is healthy, what is not, what is at risk.	State your assumptions and conclusions. Quantify the size of each issue and opportunity.	Recommend 2 or 3 specific actions for FY2018. Explain trade-offs and expected impact.

QUESTIONS WORTH EXPLORING *(not a checklist, pick what tells the story best)*

- Where is revenue growing fastest, and is that growth ***profitable?***
- Which categories, sub-categories, or product lines are dragging margins down?
- What is the relationship between discounting and profit? Where does it create value vs. destroy it?
- Which customer segments and regions deserve more investment? Which deserve less?
- Are there geographies that are systematically unprofitable, and if so, what would you do about them?

WHAT WE ARE LOOKING FOR

- **Sharp problem framing:** do not just describe the data, define the real business question.
- **Clean analysis:** reproducible work, with clear charts and labeled metrics.
- **Defensible segmentation:** your framework for grouping the business should be explicit.
- **Insight over output:** a single sharp finding beats ten generic observations.
- **Specific recommendations:** "Cut SKU X by 30%" beats "focus on profitability." Quantify impact.

DELIVERABLE: A 5-slide deck (or equivalent dashboard) plus a short video recording walking through your findings. Any tool. No single right answer. We care about **how you think, not just what you find.**